

# Ashurst

Complete firm and application research — history, financials, deals, legal tech & AI, responsible business, culture, apprenticeship structure and personal application angles.

- Role:** Solicitor Apprentice
- Location:** London
- Starting salary:** £28,000 per annum
- Hours:** 9.30am – 5.30pm
- Study partner:** The University of Law (one day a week)
- Programme length:** ~6 years — LLB (Hons) + SQE 1 & 2, fully paid
- Start date:** September 2026
- Deadline:** Midday, Friday 13 February 2026

|                                         |   |
|-----------------------------------------|---|
| 1. Firm Overview & History              | — |
| 2. Strategic Growth & Financials        | — |
| 3. Major Corporate Transactions         | — |
| 4. Practice Areas & Services            | — |
| 5. Legal Tech & AI                      | — |
| 6. Culture & Global Mobility            | — |
| 7. Responsible Business & Social Impact | — |
| 8. Inclusion, Diversity & Belonging     | — |
| 9. What Sets Ashurst Apart              | — |
| 10. Apprenticeship — Role Details       | — |
| 11. Main Responsibilities               | — |
| 12. Entry Requirements & Training       | — |
| 13. Essential Skills & Qualities        | — |
| 14. Insights, Podcasts & Resources      | — |
| 15. Personal Fit & Application Angles   | — |
| 16. Values (Quick Reference)            | — |

## 1. Firm Overview & History

- Ashurst is a leading progressive global law firm with a rich history spanning more than 200 years
- Proud of its history while being future-focused, having expanded into new technologies through its NewLaw division, Ashurst Advance, and its consulting arm
- Deep understanding of clients and a commitment to excellent service has made it a trusted adviser to local and global corporates, financial institutions and governments across all areas of commercial law
- Ashurst's perspective isn't limited by the world as it is, but inspired by the world as it could be — committed to a sustainable present and future for its people, clients and communities
- Applicants who accept a job offer undergo professional verification and background checks (with consent, per legal/regulatory obligations)

## 2. Strategic Growth & Financials

|                    |                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FY2025 revenue     | Surpassed £1 billion for the first time, after nine years of consecutive growth                                                                               |
| Partner promotions | A record cohort of 30 new partners, with significant investment in disputes and energy transition practices                                                   |
| Pending merger     | Proposed merger with U.S. firm Perkins Coie, to create <b>Ashurst Perkins Coie</b> — a top-20 global law firm with ~3,000 lawyers and ~\$2.7bn annual revenue |

The proposed Perkins Coie merger is described as one of the most significant transatlantic legal tie-ups of 2025/26, expanding reach across technology, energy, infrastructure and finance sectors, and strengthening global reach and cross-border legal leadership.

## 3. Major Corporate Transactions

- eToro** — advised on regulatory aspects of its \$620m Nasdaq IPO (May 2025)
- Tritax Big Box** — advised on a £1bn warehouse portfolio acquisition from Blackstone, a large UK real estate transaction
- Aviva** — advised Citi and Goldman Sachs as financial advisers on Aviva's £3.7bn takeover of Direct Line Group
- Carr's Group plc** — advised on a £70m tender offer, showcasing multi-disciplinary corporate work

## 4. Practice Areas & Services

M&A

INFRASTRUCTURE M&A

GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE

ECM

RISK ADVISORY

CORPORATE

EXECUTIVE INCENTIVES

PENSIONS

CORPORATE CRIME

FINANCIAL REGULATION

DATA PRIVACY

EMPLOYMENT

ENVIRONMENT & SAFETY

- Market-leading position across key sectors, providing deep industry insight via dedicated industry teams — helping clients prioritise big issues and navigate requirements with confidence
- Prides itself on deal execution and risk management skills to achieve the best possible outcome on M&A transactions
- The Global Infrastructure M&A team provides integrated specialist acquisition and financing advice across all infrastructure asset classes, including energy and renewables, transport, digital, social infrastructure, and power and utilities
- The Governance & Compliance team addresses the needs of directors, general counsel and company secretaries of public and larger private companies, helping clients navigate the regulatory environment and adopt best practice
- This team works closely with Ashurst's expanded Risk Advisory consultancy, adding technical expertise and critical thinking to operationalise responses to legal and regulatory risk — including crisis situations such as cyber attacks and fraud
- A balanced ECM practice regularly acts on high-profile work, from large, ground-breaking transactions to smaller deals requiring innovative structures

## 5. Legal Tech & AI

- Ashurst Advance** — the firm's technology team, providing advanced electronic collaboration, automation and tools for faster, cost-effective legal services
- In June 2024, Ashurst onboarded its first generative AI solution for client work through a partnership with Harvey — becoming the first global law firm to roll out Harvey across all offices globally from day one, giving access to all 4,300+ of its people worldwide
- Also deployed: M365 Copilot, Relativity Contract, Reveal AI, and Relativity aiR for advanced legal workstreams
- Founding law firm member of the UK AI industry association's legal working group (UKAI) — positioning the firm at the centre of shaping AI regulation
- As AI adoption accelerates, the firm emphasises staying ahead of the regulatory curve and ensuring safeguards are in place for responsible AI use

What sets us apart in the market is our people and how we work together — with our clients and one another. We bring together

## 6. Culture & Global Mobility

---

- Provides opportunities for employees to grow and develop careers within the firm, with a global footprint that continues to expand and evolve
- Committed to career development through a consistent, coordinated approach to global mobility — offering short-term international assignments, overseas client secondments, long-term assignments, and permanent international transfers
- Committed to working environments that support people to perform at their best — prioritising high performance, flexible work practices, authentic connections, personal authority and choice, and accountability
- Hybrid working model enables working across locations (office, home, or alongside a client) and at the times of day when performance is best
- One of the first law firms to become a signatory of the **Mindful Business Charter (MBC)** — a collective commitment to changing avoidable working practices that cause mental health and wellbeing issues
- The MBC promotes conversations on this topic and directs more thoughtful, considered working methods that reduce unnecessary individual and team stress
- Additional wellbeing benefits include free access to Headspace

## 7. Responsible Business & Social Impact

---

- The Social Impact programme focuses on increasing access to opportunities for communities and individuals experiencing marginalisation, disadvantage, financial exclusion and/or hardship
- Centres on using the professional (non-legal) skills of its people to support those in need, alongside partner community organisations across the global network
- Volunteering is a pivotal, rewarding part of this work — helping people give back, develop new skills, and gain perspective

### Access Ashurst — social mobility

- The firm's longest-running social mobility programme, running since 2011
- Has created new pathways into the legal profession for students from low socio-economic backgrounds
- Provides paid work experience at the London office and with commercial client partners, building confidence, networks and insight into commercial law firm life
- Many alumni have gone on to build successful legal careers, including at Ashurst itself
- Since 2022, over 480 students have joined the programme, from more than 390 schools across the UK

## 8. Inclusion, Diversity & Belonging

---

- Inclusion, Diversity and Belonging (IDB) is treated as more than a buzzword — an ambitious Global IDB Strategy sets out commitments across inclusion priorities
- IDB champions across the global firm and practice areas come together in the Committed to Change Advisory Group, chaired by the Global Managing Partner, Paul Jenkins
- Employee networks, function heads, partners and executive sponsors lead in identifying priorities and championing engagement in IDB-driving behaviours
- Transparent targets are set for gender, ethnicity, sexual orientation and disability, keeping the firm focused on real progress

### Recognition

- Top 20 Employers for Social Mobility — Social Mobility Foundation's Employer Index 2024
- Best CSR Initiative — UK People in Law Awards 2023

## 9. What Sets Ashurst Apart

---

1. **Outpaces change, rather than just keeping up** — doesn't just react to trends but anticipates and leads them through forward thinking and innovation
2. **Pro bono as a standalone practice, not a side activity** — set criteria and goals (citizenship and displacement, modern slavery, diversity, etc.); a long-standing internal target of a minimum 52 hours of pro bono per lawyer; recently surpassed 76,000 pro bono hours firm-wide; a unique Pacific Islands pro bono practice with targeted objectives for that region
3. **Embraces innovation through social media storytelling** — highlights firm culture and diversity on Instagram, standing out through how it tells real stories on digital platforms
4. **Founding member of UKAI** — the UK AI industry association's legal working group, putting the firm at the forefront of shaping AI regulation

## 10. Apprenticeship — Role Details

|                 |                                                           |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Role            | Solicitor Apprentice                                      |
| Location        | London                                                    |
| Reporting to    | Supervisor                                                |
| Hours           | 9.30am – 5.30pm                                           |
| Starting salary | £28,000 per annum                                         |
| Start date      | September 2026                                            |
| Deadline        | Midday, Friday 13 February 2026 (online application form) |

The Ashurst solicitor apprenticeship is an alternative route to qualification as a solicitor in England & Wales, outside of the traditional training contract. Designed to help school leavers kick-start their career with a structured learning programme, apprentices study part-time with The University of Law one day a week, while gaining hands-on experience across a wide range of legal work. The qualification combines the legal knowledge required for a new entrant to the profession with the technical demands expected of a junior lawyer.

The programme takes approximately six years and includes completing an LLB (Hons) degree and the solicitor qualifying exams (SQE 1 & 2) — all fully paid.

*We will invest the time and resources into ensuring our apprentices are fully equipped with the tools for success in the legal sector. In return, we expect commitment, motivation and a genuine interest in helping our clients.*

— Firm statement

## 11. Main Responsibilities

Exact responsibilities depend on department, but expected tasks include:

- File opening and closure on the case management system
- Document management
- Drafting invoices
- Producing correspondence and reports as required
- Preparing files and bundles
- Handling telephone communication from colleagues and clients
- Assisting fee earners with caseload, subject to close supervision
- Carrying out basic legal and business research
- Assisting Partners and Associates with various tasks
- Ensuring confidentiality and security of all firm and client documentation, data and information
- Assisting in the overall efficient running of the team
- Attending departmental training sessions
- General administration — e-filing, photocopying, scanning
- As experience grows: attending client meetings, producing attendance notes, running parts of files

Risk and Control: ensuring all activities and duties are carried out in full compliance with regulatory requirements and internal policies.

## 12. Entry Requirements & Training

- Delivered by a combination of online and face-to-face training from The University of Law, plus on-the-job learning
- Assessment includes exams, coursework and a portfolio of evidence
- The University of Law is one of the UK's leading providers of legal education and training, having trained more legal professionals at different career stages than any other provider

### Academic entry requirements

- 3 A Levels at Grade C or above (or equivalent)
- 5 GCSEs (including Maths and English) at grade C/4 or above
- Prior study of law is not required

## 13. Essential Skills & Qualities

### Skills required

- Good IT literacy, including familiarity with Microsoft Office
- Strong communication skills, both verbal and written
- Excellent organisation and time management skills
- Excellent attention to detail

### Personal qualities

- Team player, reliable, conscientious
- Enthusiastic and keen to learn
- Adaptable in approach, resilient
- Proactive, demonstrates initiative
- Able to meet deadlines and work under pressure
- Able to multi-task and prioritise effectively
- Willing to take responsibility; passionate about excellence

**Application tip:** focus on the personal skills you already have. Combining unique perspectives (e.g. marketing, psychology and law) to generate tailored solutions — using audience insight, strategic communication and accuracy to make complex ideas clear and engaging — is a strong angle, especially when paired with a track record of gathering feedback and adapting your approach.

## 14. Insights, Podcasts & Resources

- Top 5 M&A trends for 2025 and predictions for 2026 — [ashurst.com/en/insights](https://www.ashurst.com/en/insights)
- "Outpacing Change" — [ashurst.com/en/outpacing-change](https://www.ashurst.com/en/outpacing-change)
- "Is AI the New Gold Rush?" — [ashurst.com/en/insights](https://www.ashurst.com/en/insights)
- Podcasts: ESG Matters, Legal Outlook, and Business Agenda — all via [ashurst.com/en/podcasts](https://www.ashurst.com/en/podcasts)

### First-hand apprentice account (published on Ashurst's site)

- Deciding between an apprenticeship and university depends on the individual and their personality; an apprenticeship suits someone fairly certain they want to become a solicitor, as it's a larger commitment than a typical degree
- The biggest challenges came in the first few weeks — the level of professionalism, responsibility and everyday networking required was a shock coming straight from school, but proved formative
- Time management and prioritisation took a few months to grasp
- Meeting a large number of lawyers and non-lawyers across the firm taught different lessons from each; watching how others work daily, and finding your own place in the team, develops both legal knowledge and interpersonal skills quickly
- Opportunities are wide-ranging — including client secondments (seeing how an in-house legal team operates) and international secondments connecting with colleagues in other offices

## 15. Personal Fit & Application Angles

Drafted talking points connecting personal motivations and experience to the firm's positioning — for use/refinement in application answers.

### Impact & Inclusion

Ashurst's structured pro bono and community engagement mirrors experience supporting Year 7s — facilitating comfort, confidence and access to opportunities, emphasising impactful contribution over token activities.

### Interdisciplinary thinking

Ashurst's integration of legal, consulting and technology solutions resonates with work combining marketing, psychology and legal ambassadorship — showing readiness to thrive when solving complex, multi-layered problems.

### Growth mindset & innovation

Just as Ashurst pushes to outpace change, embracing innovation in communication (e.g. TikTok video strategy, social media engagement) demonstrates readiness to adapt and lead.

### Leadership & community

Ashurst's ambitious global IDB and responsible business strategy reflects leadership in house captaincy, school council and ambassador roles — creating inclusive spaces and advocating for peers.

### Additional angle — taking initiative

Ashurst outpaces change rather than just reacting to trends, leading through forward thinking and innovation. This links to taking initiative before being asked — leading marketing projects and a full rebrand instead of waiting for instructions, developing feedback forms for tours, and constantly identifying gaps that could be improved through new ideas and collaboration between students and teachers. An "ahead of the curve," constantly learning mindset would serve well in anticipating trends in a commercial environment.

## 16. Values (Quick Reference)

|                               |                     |                                   |                 |                               |                       |
|-------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------|
| OUTPACING CHANGE & INNOVATION | QUALITY             | COLLABORATION                     | PROBLEM SOLVING | HOLISTIC COMMERCIAL DECISIONS | UNDERSTANDING MARKETS |
| MULTI-JURISDICTIONAL ADVICE   | COMMERCIAL INSTINCT | MOTIVATION, DRIVE & DETERMINATION |                 |                               |                       |

Sources: [ashurst.com](https://www.ashurst.com) practice, insights and careers pages; firm press releases (2025/26); UK People in Law Awards; Social Mobility Foundation Employer Index. Compiled as private research — verify current salary, deadline and programme details against the live listing before applying.